

EMERIC PARTOS

**** DESIGNER ****

BIOGRAPHY

EMERIC PARTOS, a native of Hungary, dates his fashion career from the day, in Paris, when he visited a couturier's establishment with an aunt who lived in Paris. He had a brief period of training in the Geneva atelier of a well known jewelry designer. After working as an unpaid apprentice in the work rooms of various couture houses, PARTOS moved up and worked as a modelist, but since employers were prone to regard his favorite designs as impossible to execute, he decided, to take the plunge as an independent designer -- producer of ready to wear "little black" dresses for a Parisian boutique on the Fauborg St. Honore. His dresses caught the eye of another young Paris designer, Christian Dior, and forecast a postwar affiliation with the house of Christian Dior which was to last until he came to America. PARTOS joined the French army, and after demobilization he became a French underground operative in a group commanded by Alex Maguy, the couturier and costume designer. After the liberation, PARTOS joined Maguy as a designer. Here he had his first taste of designing coats, and was assigned, to execute the costumes for the Serge Lifau Ballet company's production of "Chetta". After his affiliation with Maguy, EMEERIC PARTOS joined the house of Dior, and it was here, that he met Bill Filson, who was destined to become his "can't do without man". Philadelphia born, Mr. Filson was in Paris on a G.I. bill studying design, at the Chambre Syndicale

De la Couture Parisienne and later at the Ecole Gerre Lavine, which offers the most complete system of pattern making. This is what makes a great association between Mr. Partos and Mr. Pilson, PARTOS designs Mr. Pilson executes to such perfection, his so called "canvasses" can be worn as perfect cloth coats.

It was also at Dior that PARTOS met Toni Hollingsworth, who has remained his favorite model through the years, as all his designs are executed on her. Toni, a top, photographic and show model, was in Paris on her way to Africa, to join a safari. When Mr. Dior heard she was in Paris, he asked her if she would like to model in his house for a season and she accepted. Little did Toni and Mr. Partos know they were to meet again a few years later at Bergdorf Goodman.

After three years with Dior, Mr. Partos became intrigued by an invitation from the late great furrier Maximilian to come to the United States as his guest and consultant fur designer, he asked Dior for a three month leave of absence for himself and his associate Mr. Pilson. At the end of three months, feeling the tremendous possibilities in new approaches to fur designing, he asked for a termination of his Dior contract and became a permanent --- and dedicated --- designer of furs.

In 1955, Bergdorf Goodman lured Mr. Partos away from Maximilian and once again in 1956, did Mr. Partos' path crossed with Toni's. Since that time it has resolved into a perfect working team. EMMER

Emeric Partos, Bill Pilson, Toni Hollingsworth and Bergdorf Goodman.

Year after year the reviews speak for themselves. His greatest honor and triumph came when, our First Lady, Jacqueline Kennedy, having seen a picture in the New York Herald Tribune of a sable cape designed by Emeric Partos, ordered it to be copied in peau d'ange (angel skin satin), to be her inaugural cape. Emeric Partos' name will remain in the annals of history for eventually his design of Jacqueline Kennedy's inaugural cape will be on display in the Smithsonian Institute.

Mr. Partos deserves the title "Titan of the Furs" or the "Rodin of the Fashion World".

He began his career as an independent designer in 1935 when he made "fashion black" dresses for a Parisian boutique on the Faubourg St. Honoré. His dresses caught the eye of another young Paris designer, Christian Dior, and through a personal acquaintance with the owner of Christian Dior's shop he was able to land work in 1937.

Partos joined the Christian Dior firm and worked as a designer in the fashion department. He was a great admirer of Aline May, the partner and creative designer, after the liberation, Partos joined May as a designer. When he was the first male in Christian Dior's firm and he designed the clothes for the first time. He worked on the production of "Dior's".

After the liberation and May's death, Partos joined the firm of Dior and in 1945, when he was still young, he was appointed as Dior's first male designer. He designed the clothes for Dior's first collection in 1946. He was the first male designer in Dior's firm and he worked for Dior until 1950. He was the first male designer in Dior's firm and he worked for Dior until 1950.